Inflammation - e.g., Vaginitis- inflammation in the vagina, urethritis- inflammation in the urethra,endocervicitis- inflammation inside the cervix, epididymitis - inflammation in the epididymis, prostatitis - inflammation in the prostate gland.

Keystone species-A species whose loss from an ecosystem would cause a greater than average change in other species population or ecosystem process.

Locus – The particular point on the chromosome at which the gene for a given trait occurs.

Macrophage - A large, leucocyte derived from a monocyte that functions in phagocytosis.

Malt - Mucosal Associated Lymphoid Tissue collective terms for secondary lymphoid organs located along various mucous membrane surfaces including Peyer's patches, tonsils, appendix.

Mast cell - A bone marrow derived cell.

Menarche – Starting of the first menstrual period.

Merozoite - A trophozoite of Plasmodium found in RBC or liver cells.

Methanogenesis – Conversion of acetate, H_2 and CO_2 into methane by methane producing bacteria.

Molecular biology – The branch of biology which attempts to interpret biological events in terms of the physico chemical properties of molecules in a cell.

Molecular Pharming – Production of active pharmaceutical substances in genetically moldified organisms.

Mould – An impression of a complete organism or a part of it in the rock that surrounds it.

Multiple Sclerosis– It is a demyelinating disease in which the insulating covers of nerve cells in the brain and spinal cord are damaged.

Mutation – Sudden and inheritable changes.

Narcotic - A powerful drug that produces, relaxed, dreamy state, derived from Opium plant.

Nascent RNA – Nascent RNA is an immediately formed RNA. In this RNA no post transcriptional modification had occured.

NBOD – Nitrogenous BOD.

Nk cells - Natural Killer cells that kill infected and tumor cells.

Nondisjunction – Nondisjunction is the failure of homologous chromosomes or sister chromatids to separate properly during cell division.

NPK fertilizers– Fertilizers with Nitrogen (N), Phosphorus (P) and Potassium (K).

Nucleosome – A morphologically repeating unit of DNA containing 190 base pairs of DNA folded together with eight histone molecules.

Null cell - A small population of peripheral blood lymphocytes that lack the membrane markers characteristic of B and T cells. Natural killer cells are included in this group.

Ontogeny – Life history of an individual.

Oocyte – The encysted zygote of Plasmodium

Operon – A cluster of genes whose expression is controlled by a single operator.

Panspermia – Units of life in the forms of spores.

Permafrost – Any ground that remains completely frozen (32°F (0°C) or colder) for at least two years straight. These permanently frozen grounds are most common in regions with high mountains and in Earth's higher latitudes near the North and South Poles.

Phenotypic plasticity -The ability of one genotype to produce more than one phenotype when exposed to different environments.

Phylogeny – Record of ancestral history.

Planetesimals - Planetesimals are the fundamental building blocks of the planets as well as the ancestors of asteroids and comets.

Polypeptide chain– It consists of smaller subunits or amino acids that are linked together. They are the building blocks of proteins.

Postpartum – Period of life following childbirth.

XII Std Biology-Zoology Glossary EM.indd 220 23/12/2022 13:33:24